

Chapter 144-4

She had only been reminiscing about Lin Luoxi's romantic issues during university, yet she accidentally thought of Liang Shi again.

Xu Qingzhu's heart felt like a green lime—sour and bitter.

Her expression naturally wasn't good.

Lin Luoxi had been watching her the whole time and could naturally notice her subtle changes. While she was lost in thought, Lin Luoxi waved a hand in front of her face. "What are you thinking about?"

Only then did Xu Qingzhu pull her wandering thoughts back. "Nothing..."

"Because I went through having a partner who wasn't good at talking." Lin Luoxi said: "Someone like Sally is rare and precious. Other than not telling me about that thing at graduation, everything else... has been pretty good."

"Pretty good?" Xu Qingzhu was puzzled.

"Yeah." Lin Luoxi said: "What else? Did you think it was exceptionally good?"

Xu Qingzhu: "..."

"I'm not looking for a perfect lover." Lin Luoxi shrugged: "She can actually only score 70 points, but because I like her, she's full marks. Objectively, all her flaws exist, but subjectively, I can be blind to them."

Without realizing it, Xu Qingzhu had been fed another mouthful of dog food.¹

But...

"Then how did you confirm that she likes you?" Xu Qingzhu asked: "Not just from what she says, but... you clearly feel she treats you well, yet you still feel like she'll leave, that she doesn't actually like you that much, that everything she does is just out of obligation... Like when you and Sally got back together, how did you confirm whether she truly liked you, or whether she just wanted to sleep with you or was using you to pass the time..."

Xu Qingzhu paused, pressed her lips together, and said with some annoyance: "Sorry, I didn't mean to offend."

"I know." Lin Luoxi looked at her. "Zhuzi, you've been so sensitive lately."

Xu Qingzhu was startled: "Huh? Have I?"

"Yes." Lin Luoxi nodded. "Is it because of Liang Shi's coma? You keep feeling like she doesn't love you?"

Xu Qingzhu nodded, then shook her head.

After a moment, she sighed helplessly, lowering her eyes: "I don't know either."

Sometimes she felt Liang Shi loved her very much, and sometimes she felt Liang Shi was just doing it for a task.

This was probably the sorrow of being a detail-oriented person.

She could find evidence that Liang Shi loved her from the details, and she could also find evidence that Liang Shi didn't love her from the details.

So she didn't know.

"Let me answer your earlier question first." Lin Luoxi organized her thoughts. "First of all, I know Sally very well. We've already passed the stage of needing to confirm whether we love each other. At most, what I need to confirm is how much she loves me. Can it surpass her career or other people? But I think these things are meaningless."

Lin Luoxi said: "It's impossible for anyone's life to only have love in it. Just like if I were in Sally's position back then, I would have chosen to go back without hesitation too, because I had responsibilities I had to fulfill. It's just a matter of whether to discuss it with your partner. One of Sally's bad traits is that she likes to avoid things. Back then, she wanted to tell me many times, but she was afraid I'd get angry, so she kept putting it off..."

Put it off until they broke up.

The pen between Xu Qingzhu's fingers kept spinning.

After a long while, Lin Luoxi helped her reach a conclusion: "It's because of Liang Shi's coma, isn't it? Plus these past few days with your heat period, you two have been glued together all day. You've had too much free time."

Xu Qingzhu: "..."

"I have work too." Xu Qingzhu retorted: "I just can't help but think about it."

Lin Luoxi stared at her, looking at her expression that was startled yet somewhat dazed. She reached out her long arm to ruffle her hair, unable to help but laugh: "Young lady, you're in love."

Xu Qingzhu: "...Haven't I always been in love?"

"No." Lin Luoxi said: "You've entered the honeymoon phase."

Xu Qingzhu: "..."

She humbly sought advice from Lin Luoxi again, and Lin Luoxi said this was probably a path every couple had to go through.

There would be a long adjustment period.

To adjust to each other's speaking habits, living habits, personalities, including all the little mannerisms.

Half of all couples' love dies during the adjustment period.

Because during the adjustment period, you'll discover this person isn't as wonderful as you imagined, and you'll constantly doubt them because of their actions.

"Then how do you resolve it?" Xu Qingzhu asked.

Lin Luoxi: "Communicate tirelessly, suppress the urge to kill her eight hundred times, and tell her how she should talk to you, how she should take care of your fragile heart, how she should give you a sense of security."

Xu Qingzhu: "..."

"But before that, you have to figure out what you want. What is your sense of security based on?" Lin Luoxi said: "Relationships are like studying. Some people can infer three things from one example, while others might need three examples just to learn one thing."

After saying that, Lin Luoxi stared at Xu Qingzhu and smiled helplessly: "Zhuzi, you're probably just overthinking because your heat period just ended? Wait a while and see. Don't think too much."

Xu Qingzhu nodded and didn't ask any more questions.

But Lin Luoxi added: "I've noticed that you science people easily fall into misconceptions when thinking about relationship problems."

"Hm?" Xu Qingzhu was confused.

"Emotions—especially during the dating period—people's thinking is constantly jumping around, very emotional, like you right now. But people with more rational thinking, when they think about these things, always like to use a fixed measure to compare against. It's as if there's a measuring cup placed there, and the other person's feelings for you have to exceed that amount to count as love."

"But a lot of the time, feelings are unpredictable. She might not love you today, but maybe tomorrow she will. She loves you today, but maybe tomorrow she won't. She might not even understand it herself. When it comes to changing hearts, it doesn't matter how good your partner is—so everything is based on emotion."

"You're too fragile right now." Lin Luoxi looked at her adorably dazed appearance and couldn't help but pat her head again, like petting a cat.² "My little Zhuzi, you love her way too much right now."

Xu Qingzhu stubbornly refused to admit it: "...It's okay, I guess."

"Oh." Lin Luoxi looked into her eyes. "You only cried your makeup off for her, that's all."

Xu Qingzhu: "..."

¹ **Dog food** (狗糧): Chinese internet slang for public displays of affection between couples. When someone witnesses a couple being lovey-dovey, they say they've been "fed dog food," implying they're single and watching others be romantic like a lonely dog being fed scraps.

² **Like petting a cat** (跟Rua貓一樣): "Rua" is an onomatopoeia/slang term popular in Chinese internet culture, used to describe the action of affectionately petting, rubbing, or squishing something soft and cute, typically a cat or other fluffy animal. It conveys a sense of fondness and playfulness.